OATH AFRICA 042916-5837

DRAGO

Roberto Mito Albino

(al-BEE-no)

Minister of Agriculture, Environment and Fisheries
Republic of Mozambique

Addressed as: **Honorable Minister** | Office held since: **Jan 2025**

Roberto Mito Albino, who portrays himself as a champion for private sector-led production and institutional reform, has been dogged by procurement controversies and scrutiny over his handling of land concessions during his short tenure as a cabinet minister.

- **“Agriculture as Business”**
  Albino frames agriculture as a business requiring market discipline rather than state-led distribution. He has reiterated that competitive production—not imports—will feed Mozambique.

- **"Tempest in a Teapot"**
  Albino dismisses the various allegations against him, including linkages to illegal timber logging activities and suspicious awarding of contracts. His scandals have generated the most comments about him on social media.

While the Minister has a technocratic background, he often employs military terminology when describing his agenda, including “we have the troops to carry out the revolution” and “we want to declare open war on those who falsify seeds.”

WHY THEY MATTER

Albino is seeking foreign investment in agriculture and climate-resilient infrastructure, engaging partners who promise to reduce food imports and unlock value chains across the region.

- **Promoting Commerical Agriculture**
  Albino frames international cooperation as a business partnership where Mozambique provides market access while partners deliver technology transfer, training, and finance.

- **Welcoming Climate Finance**
  The Minister has partnered with Italy on climate finance, including carbon credits, and talked about the importance of a green economy at a recent World Green Economy Summit in Dubai.

Albino understands the limits of government, stressing that “the Ministry of Agriculture will never produce food. Who produces food? The private sector and families."

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MEETING WITH THEM

Albino is an engaging and often playful interlocutor, alternating between straightforward language and colorful phrases to charm counterparts.

- **Declarative Statements**
  The Minister uses hyperbolic language, even sloganeering, to underscore his main points. For instance, he recently said “solving hunger—because that is the priority. I would say it's the number-one, even the sole priority."

- **Humorous Asides**
  Albino uses humor and informality to set the terms of the conversation. In a recent broadcast, he warned the interviewer that he was “going to 'ruin' your question—for a good reason." He later added that "money is like wrapping paper that covers many problems."

When confronted by difficult questions, Albino tends to acknowledge the issue while projecting confidence. For example, he defended his goal of turning agriculture into a sustainable, profitable business as “easy if we don't politicize it."

ON THEIR MIND

- **President Chapo’s U.S. Visit**
  President Daniel Chapo is setting off on a six-day trip to the United States with plans to meet U.S. Vice-President JD Vance to strengthen bilateral relations. He also will visit the headquarters of Exxon-Mobil.

- **FATF Grey List**
  The Financial Action Task Force’s (FATF), a financial crimes watchdog based in France, in late October removed Mozambique, along with three other African countries after it showed “positive progress” in addressing shortcomings within agreed timeframes.

- **Force Majeure Lifted**
  The TotalEnergies-led Mozambique LNG consortium has lifted its force majeure declaration on the liquefied natural gas project in Cabo Delgado. The announcement follows a deal on how much additional cost from the lengthy stoppage the project could claim against future taxes.

- **Cashew Sector Goals**
  Mozambique plans to invest $374 million to develop the cashew sector and raise annual production from the current 158,000 tonnes to 689,000 by 2034, according to a recent statement by the Ministry of Agriculture, Environment and Fisheries.

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NETWORK

Although a relative newcomer to international affairs, Albino is diligently working to raise his profile and build bridges to global counterparts.

Albino met FAO Director-General Qu Dongyu in July 2025, and he has engaged EU, Chinese, Dutch, German, and Turkish Ambassadors to explore opportunities for cooperation. At the Mozambique–Italy Agribusiness Forum in September, he announced a deal to advance mechanization, sustainable agroforestry & reforestation, carbon-credit initiatives, and expansion of modern irrigation.

Albino is navigating the contentious world of Mozambican politics, affirming his loyalty to President Chapo while refusing to badmouth his controversial predecessor.

Albino has boasted about a “cosmic alignment” between the tasks entrusted to him by the president. Albino demurs when pressed about former Agriculture Minister Celso Correia’s allegedly fraudulent activities; Correia was a close ally and all-round fixer for former president Felipe Nyusi.

CONTROVERSIES

Albino faces sustained scrutiny from civil society watchdogs and media over procurement processes and alleged environmental crimes.

- **Conflicts of Interest**
  In August 2025, the ministry suspended a $2 million tender at the Cotton and Oilseeds Institute after allegations that the winning bidder was recently formed and potentially linked to Albino.

- **Illegal Logging**
  According to media reports, Albino is cited alongside Ecofarm and others in a case alleging illegal logging in Sofala province, with prosecutorial claims of illegal forest resource extraction punishable by twelve to sixteen years.

Albino is under pressure from leading civil society groups, including Centro de Integridade Pública (CIP) and the Centro para Democracia e Direitos Humanos (CDD), to step down from his position and accept accountability for his alleged misdeeds.

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CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- **Minister of Agriculture, Environment and Fisheries**, Republic of Mozambique (2025 - present)
- **Director General**, Zambezi Valley Development Agency (2011 to 2024)
- **National Director**, Agribusiness Promotion Center (CEPAGRI) (2006 to 2011)
- **Local Government Official**, Government of Mozambique (1990 to 2006)
- **Teacher**, Commercial Institute (Accounting School) (1987 to 1990)

BIO

Albino rose through technical and managerial roles in agriculture and regional development to reach his first cabinet position. Born in 1966 in Maputo City, Albino earned a degree in Economics and Management from Eduardo Mondlane University in 1992.

- **Making a Difference to his Country**
  Albino is particularly fond of his time at the Zambezi Valley Development Agency, posting on LinkedIn that it was a "super challenging, exciting, and above all, rewarding mission, making me feel useful to my country."

- **Supporting Sports at his Ministry**
  While Albino's personal interest in sports is unknown, his ministry in late October sponsored a soccer tournament with other governments to promote integration, exchange, and health among participants.

Albino has a preference for untucked dress shirts, often with the Ministry's logo embroidered over the left breast pocket. Albino is married. He speaks Portuguese, English, and Ronga, a local language common in southern Mozambique and some parts of South Africa.